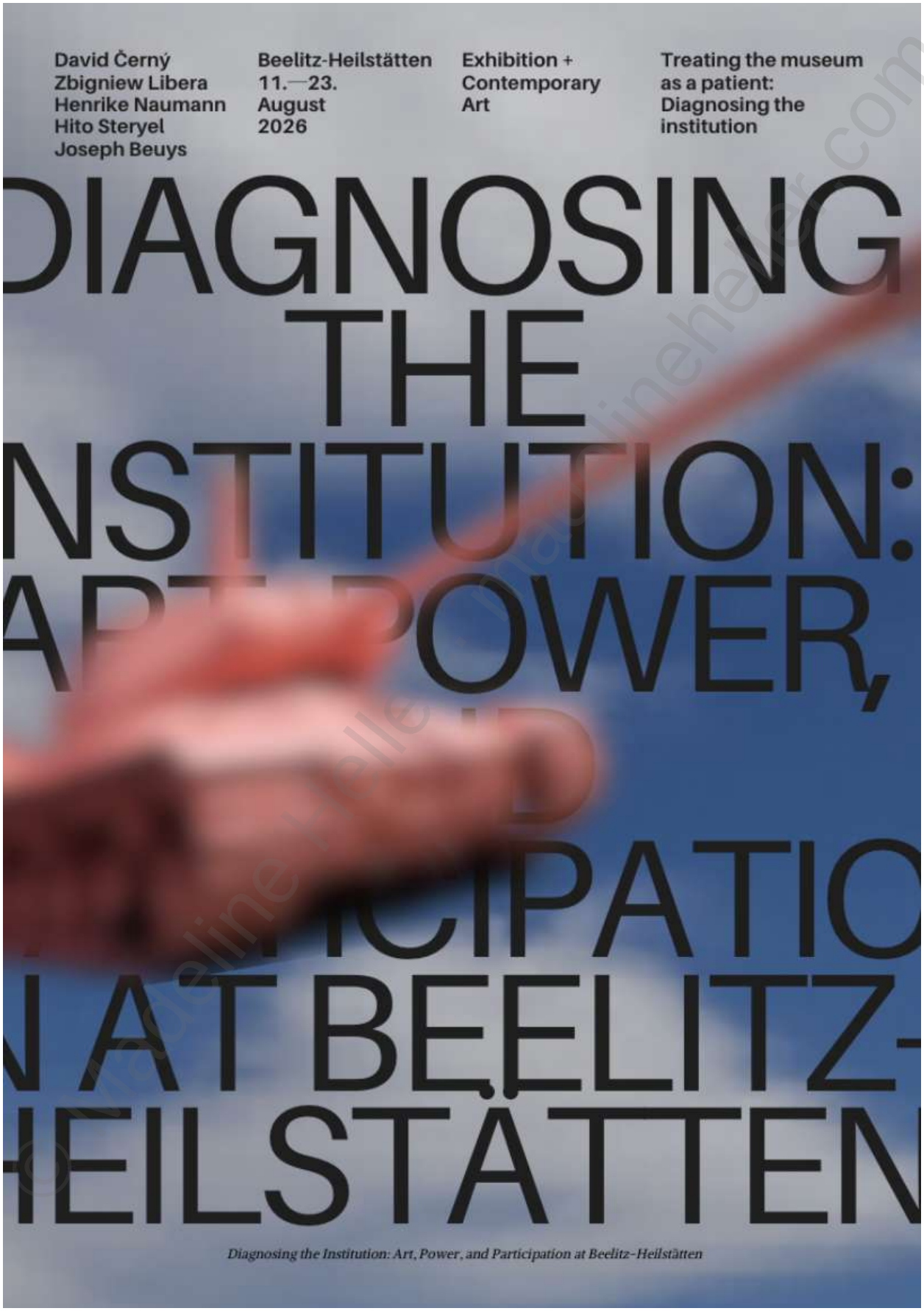


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BEELITZ-
HEILSTÄTTEN

PRESENT

DIAGNOSING THE INSTITUTION

ART, POWER, AND PARTICIPATION AT BEELITZ-HEILSTÄTTEN

11 - 23
AUG.
2026

BEELITZ-HEILSTÄTTEN - WHITNEY
HOUSTON HAUS

11 AM
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CAREY
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FORENSIC
ARCHITECTURE

FEHRAS
PUBLISHING PRACTICES

HITO
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ART EXHIBITION



BAUM&ZEIT

unesco

Landesarchiv Berlin

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Illustration: Photograph of the exterior of

The Whitney Houston Haus at the Beelitz-Heilstätten Sanatorium.

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Exhibition Proposal (2,048 Words)

Diagnosing the Institution: Art, Power, and Participation at Beelitz-Heilstätten

Can art function as a form of argument, not merely illustrating ideas, but detonating them? This exhibition is built on the conviction that museums are not neutral sanctuaries of culture; rather, they are charged sites where knowledge is manufactured, authority is legitimized, and ideology quietly reproduces itself. Rather than treating artworks as inert objects behind glass, this project positions them as live propositions, urgent, embodied arguments about power, visibility, memory, and the radical possibilities of participation. This project argues that while museums historically function as ideological state apparatuses, institutional critique and participatory practices offer pathways towards a more dialogic and socially accountable model of cultural production.

Located approximately an hour train ride outside of the city of Berlin, Germany, lies the haunting ruins of Beelitz-Heilstätten, a vast, crumbling sanatorium, encompassing around 60 complexes. This site-specific exhibition, located in the Whitney-Houston Haus, transforms a space of historical confinement into a living, critical framework. Peeling plaster, overgrown courtyards, and corridors that once carried the weight of suffering become the exhibition's first and most powerful argument. By staging works of institutional critique within a space historically defined by care, discipline, and coercive regulation, the project deliberately collapses the boundary between the medical institution and the cultural one. Both operate through spatial and visual systems designed to organize bodies, produce sanctioned knowledge, and quietly govern public behavior. The hospital and the museum emerge here as deeply parallel systems; both sort bodies, produce authoritative knowledge, and determine who is seen, who is heard, and

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who is erased. Louis Althusser's theory of ideological state apparatuses sharpens this critique, reminding us that such institutions reproduce dominant ideologies through the insidious everyday practices of representation, normalization, and aesthetic pleasure rather than through a single, overt act of coercion.

Originally constructed between 1898 and 1930 as a tuberculosis sanatorium, Beelitz-Heilstätten was a monument to modernist faith in hygiene, visibility, and spatial order. Patients were sorted by diagnosis and gender, their every movement structured by an architecture of surveillance and therapeutic control; corridors that directed, wards that isolated, windows that watched. Over the course of the twentieth century, the site was conscripted by successive regimes; a military hospital in both World Wars, then a Soviet administrative facility during the Cold War. Ideologies came and went; the architecture endured. This brutal continuity is the exhibition's most damning evidence; institutions don't merely survive through ideological consistency, but through structural adaptability; by outlasting the very regimes that built them. It is precisely this persistence, this architectural stubbornness, that forms the exhibition's conceptual spine. If a building can serve as a Wilhelmine tuberculosis ward, a Nazi military hospital, and a Soviet garrison without structural alteration, what does that tell us about the institutions we inhabit today? What does it mean for the museum to have inherited these same bones, the same logic of directed movement, organized bodies, and framed knowledge? And, most urgently, how might curatorial practice not only reflect on these structures, but actively intervene in them?

The exhibition unfolds as a spatial diagnosis, a room-by-room dissection of institutional power. Visitors, such as students, artists, and scholars, interested in the intersections of art, politics, and institutional power, as well as the local Berlin communities, are guided through a

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sequence of environments that deliberately and without comfort move from authority to participation, from control to reflection. The building itself is the first and most eloquent object of interpretation. Rather than neutralizing its decay or romanticizing its ruin, the curatorial approach insists on preserving the raw evidence of its material history, creating a somewhat clean space, while also leaving its history laid bare; residual graffiti from decades of trespassers and the ghostly traces of previous occupation. The architecture argues alongside the exhibition.

Visitors enter through the central stairwell, a space of institutional grandeur now cracked and stripped bare, and are immediately thrown into confrontation. Works by Joseph Beuys, Fred Wilson, the Guerrilla Girls, and Willehad Eilers refuse any comfortable acclimatization. Beuys's *Das Kapital Raum* (1980) breaks down the construction of meaning within the institutional frameworks; Wilson's installation cuts open the politics of display, surfacing what museums choose to bury; the Guerrilla Girls' posters deliver their indictments in blunt, unanswerable statistics. And Eilers' wall mural further adds to the layered history breathing within the institution's walls. There is no gentle introduction here. From the first step, visitors are asked to reckon with a foundational premise: the museum is not a neutral container. It is a structure shaped by power, and it has always been.

Walking past the stairwell, leading into the first room, visitors are drawn into a compressed, darkened video space; a room that hums with the anxiety of contemporary image culture. Works by Hito Steyerl and Forensic Architecture press on a single, unsettling question, asking the audience who controls what can be seen? Steyerl's *How Not to Be Seen: A Fucking Didactic Educational .MOV File* (2013) is a searing meditation on invisibility as both threat and strategy in the digital age. Alongside it, a commissioned multi-channel installation by Forensic Architecture reconstructs the spatial and historical strata of Beelitz itself, layering satellite

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imagery, archival footage, and architectural analysis to make visible what official histories have suppressed. Visibility, these works insist, is never innocent. It is always a politically mediated act.

An adjacent archive room anchors the exhibition in the granular, unsettling specificity of the site's own history. Drawn from the Berlin State Archive, the materials on display, faded photographs of patients in regimented rows, meticulous architectural blueprints, and clinical medical records, trace Beelitz's transformation across more than a century. But this is not a neutral historical display. The archive is presented as what it has always been; a constructed narrative, assembled by those with the authority to preserve and those with the power to omit. Visitors are invited or compelled to ask whose story is being told here, and at whose expense?

The exhibition then floods into the former dining hall, a vast, vaulted space where institutional critique becomes physically overwhelming. Large-scale installations and projections fill the room with confrontational density, demanding a physical as well as an intellectual response. Han Haacke, Pussy Riot, and the Guerrilla Girls return here with amplified force, their collective weight exposing the ideological and economic machinery that sustains cultural institutions. Pussy Riot's documentation of *Punk Prayer* (2012) tears through the room's grandeur; footage of masked women performing in a cathedral, of arrest, of imprisonment, of a state's naked terror at artistic dissent. The contrast is deliberate and electric; the hall's soaring architecture against the rawness of its content, beauty weaponized as critique.

At the heart of the exhibition lies the theatre space, and it is here that the project makes its most radical demand. This is not a room for looking. It is a room for doing. Works by Andrea Fraser, Tania Bruguera, and Carey Young transform the space into a live arena where institutional authority is analyzed, actively performed, and dismantled. Fraser's *Museum*

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Highlights: A Gallery Talk (1989) turns the museum tour into a devastating act of mimicry, exposing the absurdity of institutional language through its own impeccable execution. Bruguera's participatory installation places the microphone in the visitor's hands; a gesture of terrifying openness. Young's playful mixed media installation strips institutional language of its authority, revealing the cultural bureaucracy and authoritative language concealed within its measured syntax. Here, the passive observer ceases to exist. Every visitor becomes a co-author of the exhibition's meaning.

The east wing extends the exhibition's inquiry into the vast, entangled systems through which contemporary power operates. Works by Steyerl, Forensic Architecture, Lawrence Abu Hamdan, and Candice Breitz map the surveillance architectures, media ecologies, and representational politics that shape what we know and whom we believe. Abu Hamdan's sound-based work is quietly devastating; using the building's own acoustics, it transforms the act of listening into a forensic practice, an act of resistance against institutional silence. Breitz's installations fracture identity across mediated screens, interrogating the spectator's own complicity in systems of representation. Visitors do not observe this section from a safe distance; they are inside it.

A separate room is given entirely to Henrike Naumann, whose installation *Re-Education* (2022-23) is one of the exhibition's most quietly disturbing works. Naumann reconstructs the domestic interiors of ideological formation, the living rooms, the wallpapers, the furniture of belief, with an uncanny fidelity that makes the familiar feel sinister. Placed within the institutional shell of Beelitz, the work refuses the comforting separation between public and private, between the hospital and the home. Ideology, it insists, does not stop at the institution's door. It furnishes our living rooms. It shapes the rooms we grew up in.

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The west wing is where the exhibition breathes differently; slower, heavier, more interior. This is a space of grief and reckoning. Works by Gregg Bordowitz, Zoe Buckman, Zbigniew Libera, and Fehras Publishing Practices address the politics of remembrance with unflinching ethical seriousness. Libera's *LEGO. Concentration Camp (Obóz koncentracyjny)* (1996) remains one of contemporary art's most unbearable provocations; the Holocaust rendered in primary-colored plastic, horror made purchasable, atrocity packaged for the toy aisle. It is not a comfortable work, and it is not meant to be. Fehras Publishing Practices traces how historical narratives are assembled, edited, and institutionally sanctioned, and what is lost, deliberately or otherwise, in that process. Memory, this wing insists, is not preserved by institutions. It is managed by them.

The penultimate gallery reaches back to the historical foundations from which institutional critique emerged. Works by Kazimir Malevich, Ilya Kabakov, and Marcel Broodthaers trace the ideological and aesthetic origins of a tradition that this exhibition both inherits and extends. Positioned near the end of the journey, these works function as a provocation rather than a triumphant genealogy. The struggle against institutional authority is not a solved problem. It is an unfinished project, permanently in progress, permanently under threat.

The exhibition doesn't end with a statement; instead, it opens into a space with mirrors all around. In the final reflection space, visitors encounter their own image; fragmented, multiplied, inescapable, alongside quotations from artists and theorists who have spent their lives pressing against institutional walls. Here, the audience is allowed to write their own thoughts on the mirrors. It is an uncomfortable ending, and deliberately so. There is no resolution offered here, no reassuring conclusion. Throughout the exhibition, participation is not a decorative gesture; it is the architecture of the project itself. Public assemblies, artist-led discussions, and open

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workshops extend the exhibition beyond any fixed gallery boundary, transforming Beelitz into a living forum rather than a destination. Transparency, too, is treated as a curatorial principle rather than an afterthought; information about funding sources, decision-making processes, and institutional frameworks is made fully accessible to visitors. If this exhibition is to argue against the opacity of institutional power, it must be willing to expose its own. Workshops extend the exhibition beyond the gallery space, transforming it into an ongoing forum for dialogue. Transparency is also incorporated into the curatorial process, with information about funding, decision-making, and institutional frameworks made accessible to visitors.

Ethically, the project adheres to rigorous standards. It refuses the easy seduction of ruin aesthetics, the Instagram-ready decay that reduces suffering to atmosphere. It equally refuses the sensationalism that turns historical trauma into spectacle. In its place, the exhibition foregrounds critical interpretation, archival depth, and genuine accountability. Consultation with disability studies scholars and mental health practitioners has shaped the exhibition's approach at every level, ensuring that the histories of coercion embedded in this site, the forced confinements, the diagnostic violence, and the erasure of patient agency are treated with the gravity they demand. Accessibility and inclusivity are not supplementary considerations; they are foundational ones.

Ultimately, this exhibition is a demand that institutional critique move beyond the comfort of representation and into the discomfort of spatial, embodied practice. A demand that the museum stop pretending to be above the power structures it perpetuates. A demand that visitors stop pretending to be above them, either. By transforming Beelitz-Heilstätten, a site that has survived tuberculosis wards, world wars, and Cold War occupation, into a space of radical inquiry and genuine participation, this project reimagines what a museum can be; not a

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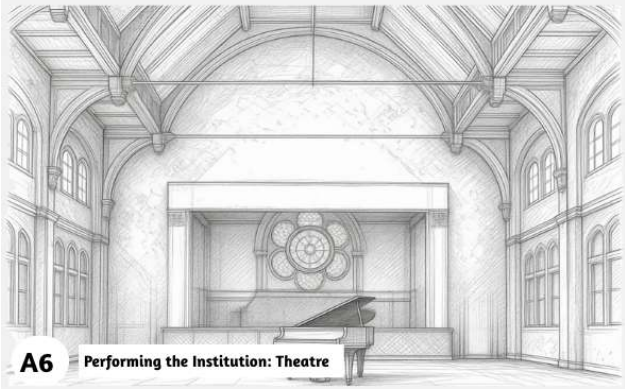
monument to cultural authority, but a contested, living, democratic public space. Here, art does not illustrate arguments. It makes them. And it makes them matter.

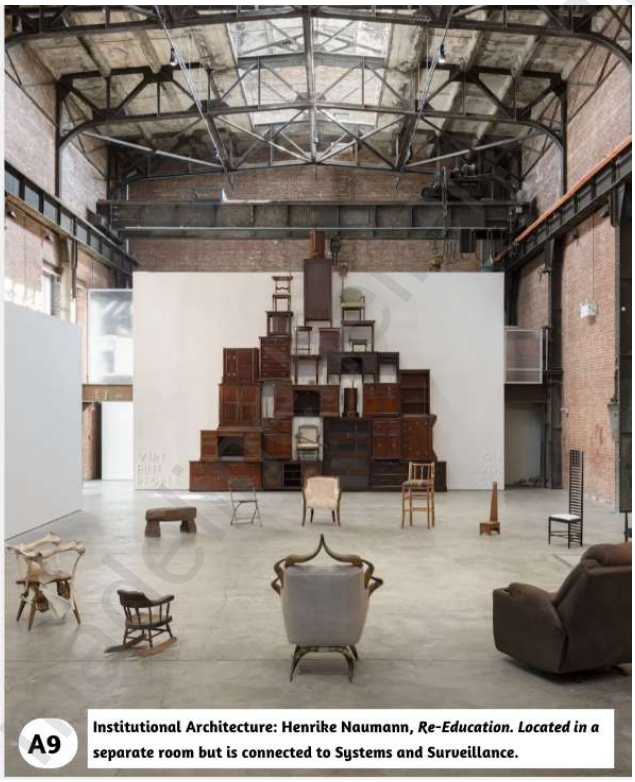
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Exhibition Space Table of Contents







A1: The Institution as Monument (Entrance space)

A2: Seating space

A3: Diagnosis & Visibility

A4: The Institutional Body: Institutions' History

A5: The Institution as Monument (Expanded) (Dining Hall)

A6: Performing the Institution: Theatre Room

A7: Systems & Surveillance: Networks of Power

A8: System & Surveillance (Continuation)

A9: Institutional Architecture

A10: Memory & Erasure

A11: Memory & Erasure (Continuation) (Bath House)

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A12: Memory & Erasure (Continuation)

A13: Historical Foundations: Origins of Control

A14: Entrance to the Reflection Room: The Institution Itself

A15: Reflection Room: The Institution Itself

A16: Dialogue and Debate: Cafe, Discussion Space & Gift Shop

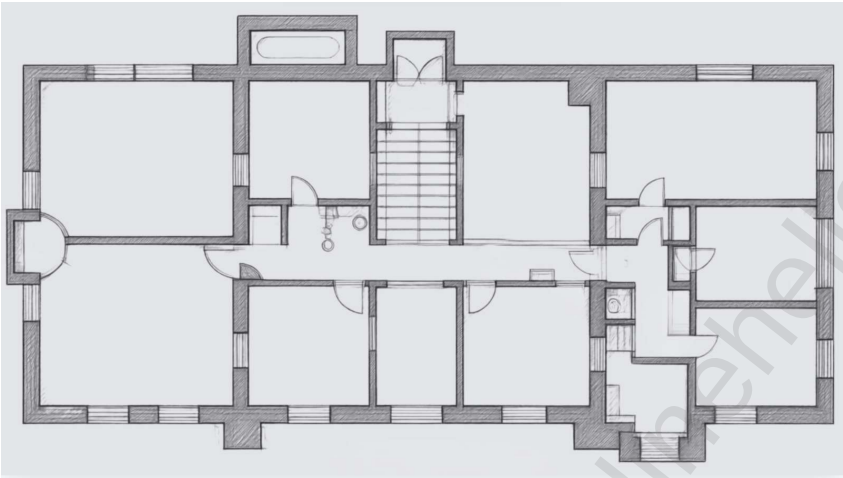
A17: Resistance & reclamation: Exterior

A18: Resistance & reclamation: Porch Exterior Space

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Proposed Exhibition Layout



Diagnosing the Institution: Art, Power, and Participation at Beelitz-Heilstätten will be located on the Ground Floor of the Whitney Houston Haus. Also known as the Men's Sanatorium.

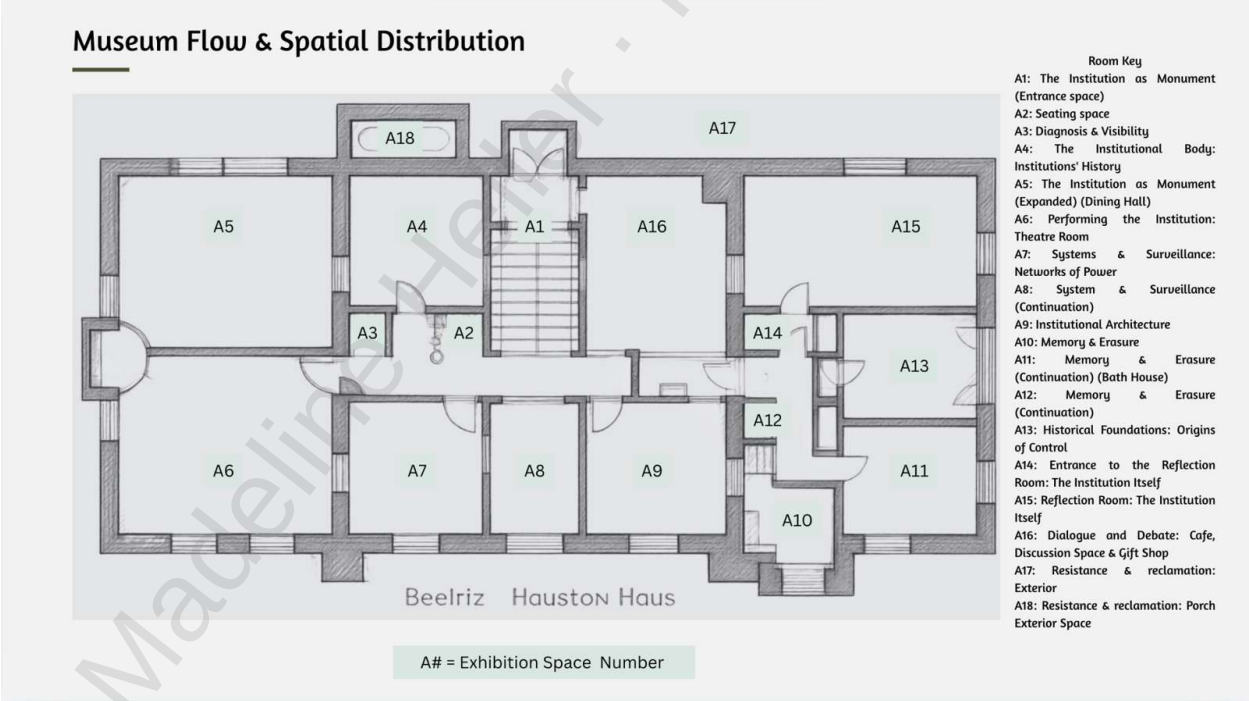
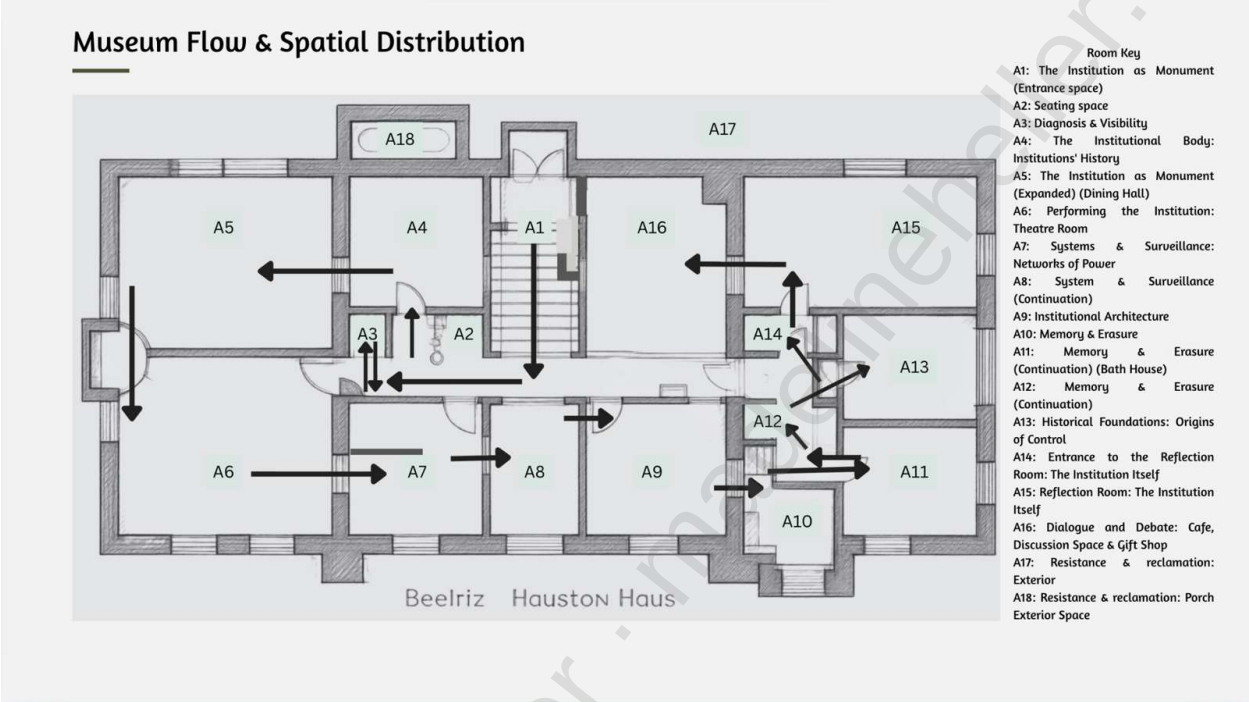


Image with the exhibition space room numbers. A total of 18 spaces are labeled. Space A2 is a seating space for those with museum fatigue or who need to rest. The beginning of the exhibition

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is meant to be overwhelming to the audience. Space A15 will be the reflection space. Space A16 is the cafe, discussion space, and gift shop. A18 is the outside porch, which is quite beautiful and a great place to view the outdoor artworks.



The arrows on the diagram are to show the flow of the exhibition. Starting in the Entrance (A1) and eventually ending at A16 (Indoors).

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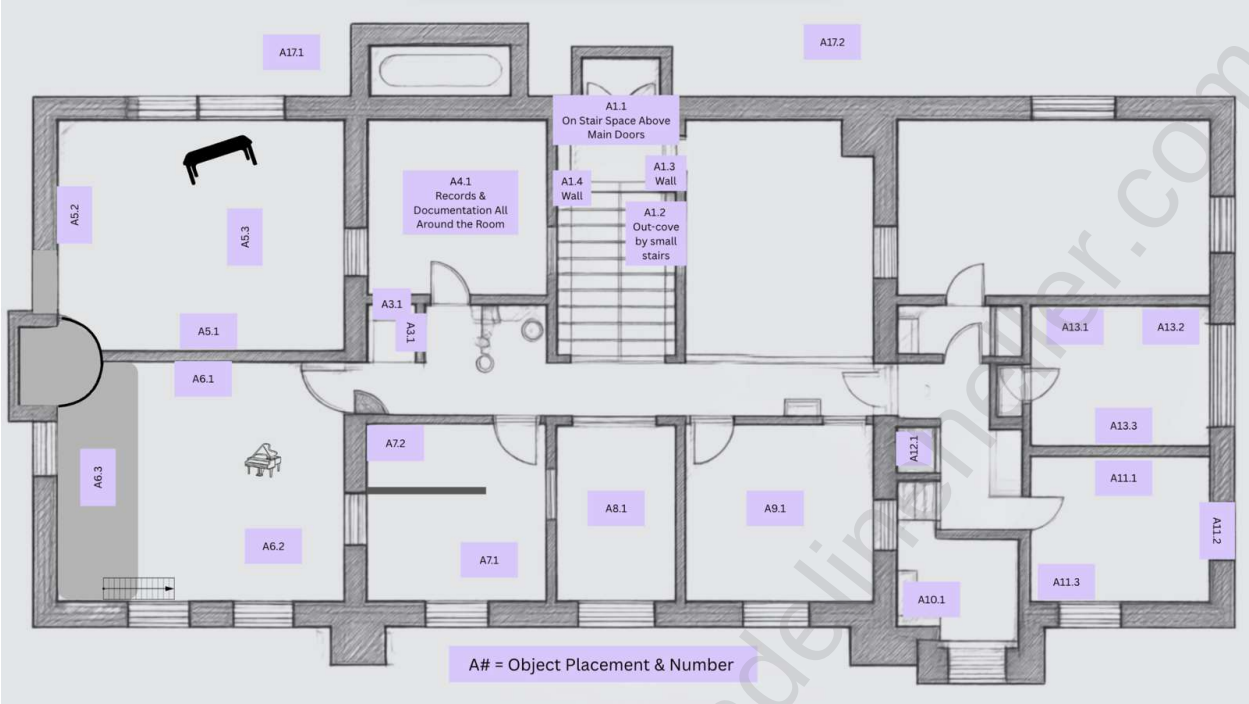
Artwork/Oject Menu

A1.1 Joseph Beuys, Das Kapital Raum
A1.2 Fred Wilson, Mining the Museum
A1.3 Guerrilla Girls, Do women have to be naked... Poster
A1.4 Willehad Eilers, Fun Girl Beach
A3.1 Hito Steyerl, How Not To Be Seen
A3.2 Forensic Architecture, Commissioned Video
A4.1 Beelitz-Heilstätten Archives
A5.1 Hans Haacke, Shapolsky et al. Manhattan Real Estate Holdings
A5.2 Pussy Riot, Punk Player
A5.3 Guerrilla Girls, Poster Collage of various Guerrilla Girls works
A6.1 Andrea Fraser, Museum Highlights
A6.2 Tania Bruguera, Tatlin's Whisper #5
A6.3 Carey Young, Welcome to the Museum
A7.1 Hito Steyerl, Factory of the Sun
A7.7 Forensic Architecture, Investigative Reconstruction, The Murder of Halit Yozgat
A8.1 Candice Breitz, Love Story
A9.1 Henrike Naumann, Re-Education
A10.1 Fehras Publishing Practices, Borrowed Faces Exhibition
A11.1 Gregg Bordowitz, Fast Trip, Long Drop
A11.2 Zoe Buckman, Champ
A11.3 Zibigniew Libera, LEGO. Concentration Camp
A12.1 Lawrence Abu Hamdan, Saydnaya (the Missing 19dB)
A13.1 Kazimir Malevich, Black Square
A13.2 Ilya Kabakov, The Man Who Flew into Space...
A13.3 Marcel Broodthaers, Museum-Museum
A17. 1 Wangechi Mutu, The NewOnes, will free Us
A17.2 David Černý, Pink Tank

Key: A# = Object Placement & Number

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Entrance Mock-Up Illustrations

Mock-up Image 1.



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Mock-up Image 2.



Mock-ups of the entrance section of the Whitney Houston Haus Exhibition.

A1.1 Joseph Beuys, *Das Kapital Raum* (1980) (Image 1. On Stairway Above Main Doors. Around the space are chalkboards that are participatory.), A1.2 Fred Wilson, *Mining the Museum* (*Metalwork Exhibition*, 1793-1880) (Image 1. Placed in the alcove on the right side.), A1.3 Guerrilla Girls, *Do women have to be naked to get into the Met. Museum?* Poster series (1980) (Image 1. Right wall), A1.4 Willehad Eilers, *Fun Girl Beach* (2003) (Image 1. Left Wall. Image 2. Right side next to the doors that guide you to the rest of the exhibition).

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Exhibition List (Total of 29 Objects for the Exhibition)

A1 – The Institution As A Monument



A1.1. Joseph Beuys, *Das Kapital Raum* (adapted installation) (installed 1980), 1970–1977 (reconfigured 2026), Mixed media installation: chalkboards, found objects, wood, metal, Dimensions variable, Lender: Adapted curatorial reconstruction based on historical installations (Hamburger Bahnhof, Berlin). Source: https://www.smb.museum/en/exhibitions/detail/joseph-beuys/.



A1.2. Fred Wilson, *Mining the Museum, Metalwork Exhibition*, 1793-1880, 1992-1993, Mixed media installation: glass vitrines, silver objects, shackles, Dimensions: 35 mm, Lender: Courtesy of the artist and Pace Gallery, New York. Source:

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https://bmoreart.com/2017/05/how-mining-the-museum-changed-the-art-world.html; https://contemporary.burlington.org.uk/journal/journal/african-art-as-found-object.



A1.3. Guerrilla Girls, *Do women have to be naked to get into the Met. Museum?*, Poster Series, 1985–ongoing, Offset print on paper, Approx. 56 × 71 cm each, Lender: Courtesy of the Guerrilla Girls. Source: https://www.guerrillagirls.com/projects.



A1.4. Willehad Eilers (A.K.A. Wayne Horse), *Fun Girls Beach*, 2003, Spray paint mural (site-integrated), Dimensions variable, Lender: Site-specific (Beelitz-Heilstätten). Source:https://waynehorse.com/work;https://www.eeacademy.eu/annual/eea03/.

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A3 - Diagnosis & Visibility: Seeing and Not Seeing



A3.1. Hito Steyerl, *How Not to Be Seen: A Fucking Didactic Educational .MOV File*, 2013, Single-channel video installation, 30 min, Dimensions variable. Lender: Andrew Kreps Gallery, New York. Description: A satirical tutorial on invisibility in the digital age, exploring surveillance, resolution, and the politics of visibility. Source: https://www.moma.org/collection/works/181784?;https://www.artforum.com/video/hito-steyerl-how-not-to-be-seen-a-fucking-didactic-educational-mov-file-2013-165845/.



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A3.2 (Commission). Forensic Architecture, *Diagnosing Beelitz*, 2026, Multi-channel video installation with architectural modeling, Dimensions variable, Lender: Commissioned for exhibition. Description: A speculative investigation into the site's historical transformations using spatial analysis and digital reconstruction.

A4 - History Room: The Institutional Body



A4.1. Beelitz-Heilstätten Archive. 1898–1990s, Photographs, architectural plans, and medical records, Dimensions variable, Lender: Berlin State Archive. Description: Archival materials tracing the sanatorium's evolution across political regimes, foregrounding the continuity of institutional structures. Source: https://baumundzeit.de/en/geschichte_en/.

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A5 - Institutional Critique (Dining Hall)



A5.1. Hans Haacke, *Shapolsky et al. Manhattan Real Estate Holdings*, 1971, Photographs and documentation, Medium: 9 photostats, 142 gelatin silver prints, 142 photocopies. Dimensions variable, Lender: Courtesy of the artist and Paula Cooper Gallery. Edition 2/2, Credit line: Purchased jointly by the Whitney Museum of American Art. Source: https://whitney.org/collection/works/29487



A5.2. Pussy Riot, *Punk Prayer*, 2012, Video documentation, Approx. 5 min, Dimensions variable. Lender: Courtesy of the collective. Source: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=smG6LYc-g4w&t=100s

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A5.3. Guerrilla Girls, Poster interventions, Poster Collage of various Guerrilla Girls works. Guerrilla Girls' Code Of Ethics For Art Museums Monument, 2019, Dimensions Variable, Lender: Guerrilla Girls. Source: https://www.guerrillagirls.com/projects.

A6 - Performing The Institution (Theatre)



A6.1. Andrea Fraser, *Museum Highlights: A Gallery Talk*, 1989, Video documentation, 29 min, Lender: Galerie Nagel Draxler. Source: https://www.artic.edu/artworks/193356/museum-highlights-a-gallery-talk.

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A6.2. Tania Bruguera, *Tatlin's Whisper #5*, 2008, Participatory performance installation, Dimensions variable, Lender: Courtesy of the artist. Source: https://www.tate.org.uk/art/artworks/bruguera-tatlins-whisper-5-t12989.



A6.3. Carey Young, *Welcome to the Museum*, 2009, Mixed media installation (part of installation on view), Professional call centre agent, script written by the artist, audio recordings, call centre software, direct dial telephone connection, telephone, chair, table. Commissioned by the Contemporary Art Museum St. Louis, Dimensions variable, Lender: Paula Cooper Gallery. Source: https://www.careyyoung.com/works#/welcome-to-the-museum.

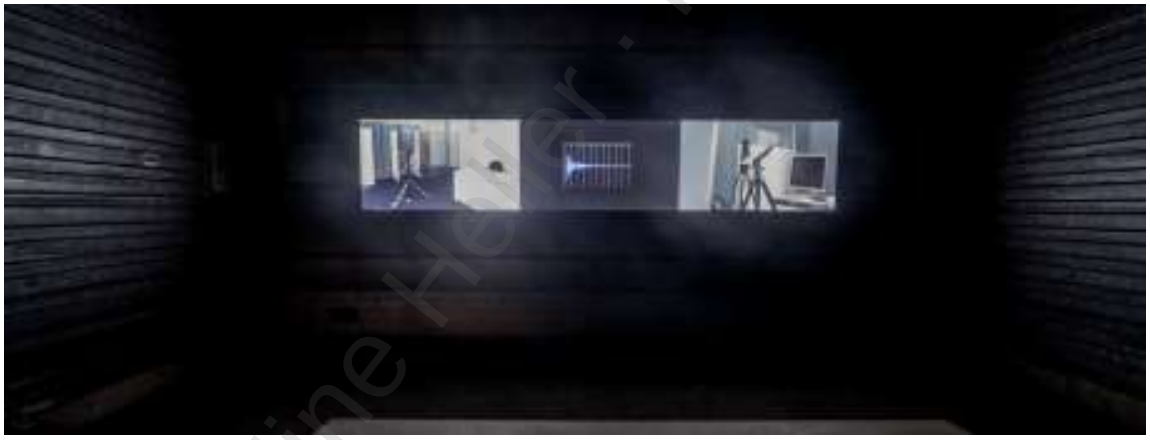
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A7 + A8 - Systems & Surveillance: Networks of Power



A7.1. Hito Steyerl, *Factory of the Sun*, 2015, Multi-channel video installation, 23 min, Lender: Esther Schipper, Berlin. Photo by J. Arnold, Impart Photography. Source: https://sjmusart.org/exhibition/hito-steyerl-factory-sun.



A7.2. Forensic Architecture, Investigative Reconstruction, *The Murder of Halit Yozgat*, 2017, Video and spatial reconstruction, Dimension variable. Lender: Forensic Architecture. Source: https://forensic-architecture.org/programme/exhibitions/77sqm_926min-documenta-14; https://www.derstandard.at/2000063484043/wir-arbeiten-im-namen-der-opfer; https://news.artnet.com/art-world/documenta-14-kassel-forensic-nsu-trial-984701.

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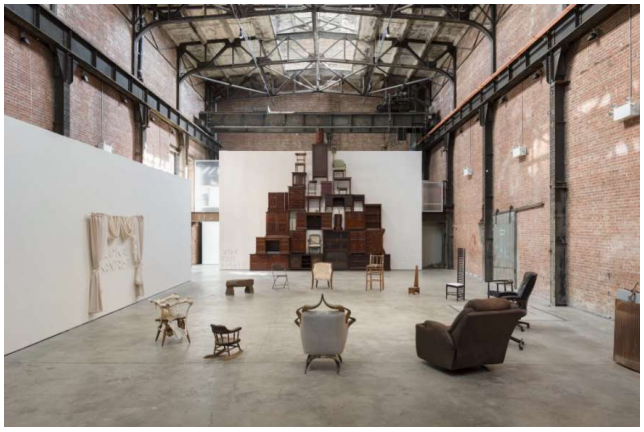


A8.1. Candice Breitz, *Love Story,* 2016, Multi-channel video installation, Dimensions variable. Lender: commissioned by the National Gallery of Victoria (Melbourne), Outset Germany, and Medienboard Berlin-Brandenburg. It was first shown at the Kunstmuseum Stuttgart in 2016, accompanied by a publication at Kerber Verlag. Text: Alexander Koch / Translation: Gerrit Jackson / Editing: Kimberly Bradley. Source: https://kow-berlin.com/artists/candice-breitz/love-story-2016.

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A9 – Institutional Architecture



A9.1. Henrike Naumann, *Re-Education,* Exhibited on 22. September 2022 – 27. February 2023, SculptureCenter, New York. Source: https://henrikenaumann.com/work/re-education/.

A10 – Memory & Erasure: The Archive and the Forgotten



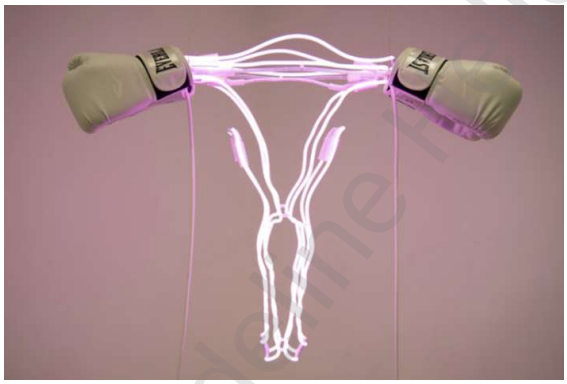
A10.1. Fehras Publishing Practices, *Borrowed Faces: A Photo Novel on Publishing Culture*, issue no. 2, Installation, documenta fifteen, Curated by Ruan Gruppe, Kassel, Germany, 18th June 202 - 25th September 2022. Lender: Fehras Publishing Practices. Source: https://fehraspublishingpractices.org/filter/Events/How-to-Reappear-MMAG-Art-Foundation-Amman.

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A11 + A12 – Memory & Erasure: The Archive and the Forgotten (Expanded)



A11.1. Gregg Bordowitz, *Fast Trip, Long Drop*, 1993, Autobiographical video essay, Dimension variable. Lender: Courtesy of artists. Source:https://www.dazeddigital.com/artsandculture/article/16777/1/gregg-bordowitzs-fast-trip-long-drop.



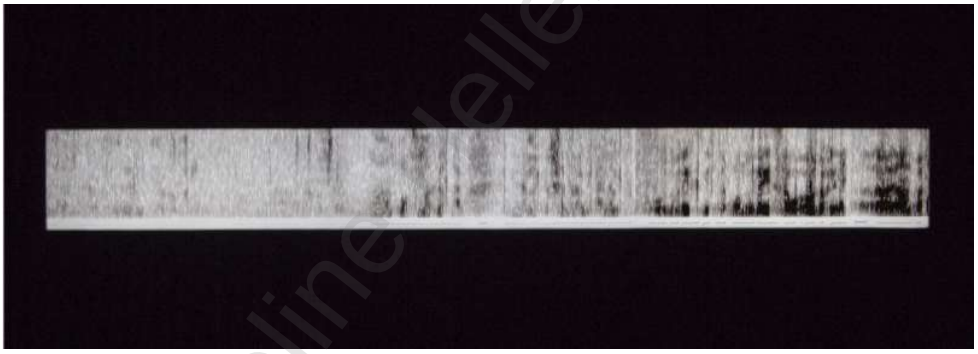
A11.2. Zoe Buckman, *Champ*, *Mostly It's Just Uncomfortable* (Exhibition), 2016, Neon, glass, leather, 30 x 18 x 10 in., Textile installation, Courtesy the artist and 21c Museum. Source: https://www.zoebuckman.com/work/mostly-its-just-uncomfortable-art/;https://www.studiointernational.com/zoe-buckman-interview-role-feminism-to-reframe-how-we-construct-masculinity.

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A11.3. Zbigniew Libera, *LEGO. Concentration Camp (Obóz koncentracyjny)*, 1996, box with Lego bricks, Various versions, including design drawings, range from approximately 9.84 x 9.45 in (approx. 25 x 24 cm), photo courtesy of the Museum of Modern Art in Warsaw. Source: https://culture.pl/en/work/lego-concentration-camp-zbigniew-libera.

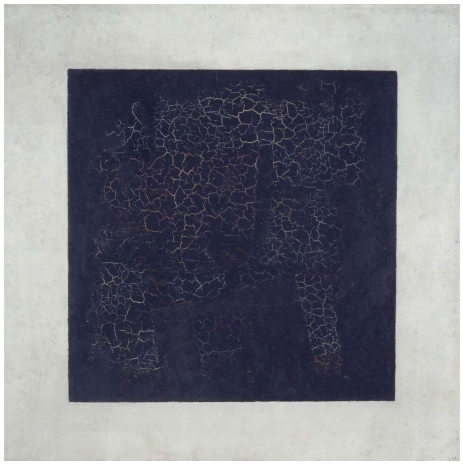


A12.1. Lawrence Abu Hamdan, *Saydnaya (the Missing 19dB)*, 2017, Installation comprising a chromogenic print in a lightbox (243 × 30.5 × 10 cm), sound piece (12:48 min.), and automated mixing deck. Source: https://hammer.ucla.edu/exhibitions/2018/hammer-projects-lawrence-abu-hamdan.

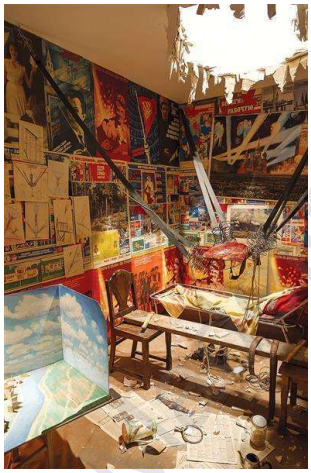
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A13 – Historical Foundations: Origins of institutional authority, utopian vision, and its collapse



A13.1. Kazimir Malevich, *Black Square*, 1915, Oil on canvas, 79.5 × 79.5 cm, Lender: Tretyakov Gallery (representative version; multiple historical iterations exist). Source: https://ideelart.com/blogs/magazine/why-was-kazimir-malevich-s-black-square-painting-so-seminal?srsltid=AfmBOopGGrq5pLZeXmXZE2A87xHqVTJfkqIhG1kH0KkoLLkdJ2JAUw5q.



A13.2. Ilya Kabakov, *The Man Who Flew into Space from His Apartment,* 1985, Mixed media installation (wooden structure, printed materials, found objects), Approx. 300 × 400 × 300 cm,

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Lender: Museum of Modern Art (or similar institutional lender). Source: https://www.kabakov.net/installations/2019/9/15/the-man-who-flew-into-space-from-his-apartment.



A13.3. Marcel Broodthaers, *Museum–Museum (Musée d'Art Moderne)*, Département des Aigles, 1968–1972, Mixed Media installation, Medium: Two screenprints, Dimensions: composition: 33 x 46 1/2" (83.9 x 118.2 cm); sheet (each): 33 x 23 1/4" (83 x 59.1 cm), Lender: Museum of Modern Art, Tate, Centre Pompidou. Source: https://www.moma.org/collection/works/65032.

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A17 - Resistance & reclamation: Institutional power in public space – Outside the museum



A17.1. Wangechi Mutu, *The NewOnes, will free Us,* 2019, Bronze sculptures, each approx. 180–200 cm tall, Lender: Metropolitan Museum of Art (original commission; traveling loans possible). Source: https://www.metmuseum.org/perspectives/wangechi-mutu-director-message.



A17. 2. David Černý, *Pink Tank*, 1991, Medium: Painted Soviet tank, Dimensions: Approx. 9–10 m long (full-scale tank), Lender: Military Technical Museum Lešany (original context; replicas/versions exhibited internationally). Source:

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https://www.azuremagazine.com/article/disaster-capitalism-the-provocative-public-art-of-prague
s-david-cerny/.

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Diagnosing THE INSTITUTION





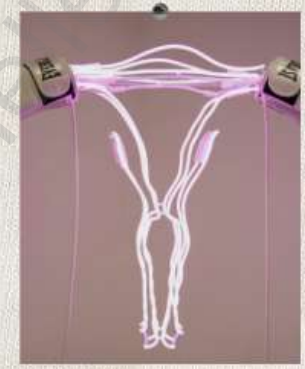








Step into the institution with a new perspective, bold creations, and timeless impact. Discover pieces made to inspire and question your everyday.









NEW EXHIBITION (26')

INFO IN BIO

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List of Text Panels (Spaces that will have a text panel)

Entrance Panel: Diagnosing the Institution - The Institution As A Monument

Diagnosis & Visibility (A3)

The Institutional Body: Institutions' History & Archive (A4)

Institutional Critique Room

Performing The Institution (Theatre)

Systems & Surveillance: Networks of Power

Memory & Erasure

Reflection: The Institution Itself

Entrance Panel: Diagnosing the Institution -The Institution As A Monument (296 Words)

This exhibition demands that we stop accepting the museum as a neutral space. These institutions are not passive containers for culture; they are architects of knowledge, power, and meaning, actively shaping what is remembered, celebrated, and erased. Through centuries of classification, selection, and deliberate exclusion, museums have reinforced dominant narratives at the expense of countless others. It is time to look them directly in the eye.

Situated within the haunted corridors of the former Beelitz Sanatorium, known as the Whitney Houston Haus, the former surgical pavilion, and the men's sanatorium, Diagnosing the Institution confronts the chilling parallels between medical and cultural systems of control. This is not a

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coincidence of venue; it is a provocation. Just as the sanatorium once seized bodies, categorized them, and subjected them to institutional will, museums seize histories, organize them, and dictate how they are told, and who gets to be heard.

This exhibition transforms the elaborate labyrinth into a diagnostic journey, one that implicates every visitor who walks through it. Moving through these charged spaces, you will encounter artworks that tear open questions of institutional authority, shatter systems of representation, and dare to imagine something different. This is not a space for passive consumption. You are not here merely to observe. You are here to participate, to question, and to help build new meaning from the ruins of old frameworks.

By gathering artists who fearlessly interrogate power, memory, and representation, this exhibition insists that the museum must become a site of radical dialogue and unflinching accountability. The question is no longer merely academic: How do institutions shape what we see, what we value, and what we forget, and how must they be reimagined? The answer begins here, now, with you.

Text Panels (Expanded. Not A Project Requirement)

Diagnosis & Visibility

Welcome to Diagnosis & Visibility. This is where the examination begins.

Visibility is not given. It is granted. It is withheld. It is manufactured by systems that operate quietly, relentlessly, and often invisibly. Who decides what appears on screen, in the archive, in

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the canon? Who is rendered legible, and who is made to disappear? These are not abstract questions. They are the mechanisms of power that shape every image you have ever trusted, every story you have ever been told.

Through urgent, arresting moving-image works, the artists in this room drag those mechanisms into the light. They expose how digital platforms and cultural institutions alike function as gatekeepers; sorting, filtering, amplifying, and erasing. They ask you to look not just at what is shown, but at the frame itself; at the edges, the cuts, the silences. At everything that has been kept from view.

This is the diagnosis. The symptoms are everywhere if you know how to look.

Institutional Critique Room

You have crossed the threshold into the Institutional Critique Room. Nothing here is accidental. Nothing is neutral.

The museum has always presented itself as a place of truth; a sanctuary of objectivity, where knowledge is carefully preserved and faithfully transmitted. But who built these walls? Who filled these vitrines? Who decided which objects were worthy of protection, and which peoples were worthy of representation? The institution does not simply reflect culture. It constructs it, curates it, and, all too often, weaponizes it.

The artists gathered in this room refuse to look away. They pry open the hidden machinery of museum authority; the acquisition policies written in boardrooms, the taxonomies inherited from colonial expeditions, the silences that stretch across entire continents and centuries. Their works

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do not merely critique; they indict. They hold the institution accountable for the stories it has told, the voices it has suppressed, and the power it has quietly, relentlessly accumulated.

Look closely at what surrounds you. The frame is part of the work. The wall text is part of the argument. Even your presence here, as a visitor granted access, guided along a prescribed path, is a condition worth questioning.

This room does not offer resolution. It offers something more valuable. The refusal to pretend that things are fine as they are.

Performing The Institution (Theatre)

You have entered the Performance section of this exhibition. And whether you realize it or not, you are already part of the performance.

Authority has always been theatrical. The museum guard is standing at attention. The velvet rope. The hushed reverence demanded in galleries. The white walls that signal, this is serious, this is important, this is beyond question. Power does not simply exist; it is performed, rehearsed, and staged, over and over, until we forget it is a performance at all.

The artists in this room tear down the fourth wall. Through live action, speech, participation, and the raw presence of the body, they expose authority as something constructed, and therefore something that can be disrupted, subverted, and reimagined. These works do not ask you to watch from a safe distance. They pull you in. They make you complicit. They make you a collaborator.

What role will you choose to play?

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Systems & Surveillance: Networks of Power

You have entered the Systems & Surveillance section. The systems, however, entered you long before you arrived here.

Every click is tracked. Every face scanned. Every search query is stored, sorted, and sold. We live inside networks of surveillance and control so vast, so seamlessly embedded in daily life, that we have largely stopped noticing them, or worse, stopped caring. Data flows invisibly through the walls of every institution, every city, every pocket. And somewhere, always, someone is watching.

The artists in this room make the invisible visible. Through video, photography, and relentless investigative practice, they map the hidden infrastructures that govern contemporary existence, the algorithms that sort us, the databases that define us, the architectures of control that shape what we can say, where we can go, and whom we are allowed to be. Their work is not paranoia. It is documentation.

Look around you. The system is already looking back.

Memory & Erasure

Listen carefully. What you cannot hear is as important as what you can.

Memory is never simply what happened. It is what was allowed to survive. Archives are not neutral repositories; they are acts of selection, of preservation and abandonment, of choosing whose grief deserves to be recorded and whose disappears without a trace. Institutions have long been the custodians of memory, which means they have long been the arbiters of forgetting. The

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histories that were inconvenient, the voices that were dangerous, the bodies that were deemed unworthy, they were not lost by accident. They were erased by design.

The artists in this room refuse that erasure. They excavate absence. They mourn what has been taken. They reconstruct fragments of lives and histories that the official record chose to omit, and they demand that we sit with the weight of that loss, not as a comfortable, distant tragedy, but as something unresolved, ongoing, and urgent.

This room is not a memorial. It is a reckoning.

Reflection: The Institution Itself

You have reached the Reflection Room. There is nowhere left to go but inward.

Throughout this exhibition, you have been asked to examine institutions; their authority, their failures, their violences. But institutions are not abstract forces that exist apart from us. They are built by people. Sustained by people. Entered, funded, legitimized, and reproduced by people. By visitors exactly like you.

This final room turns the gaze around. The artists here do not let you leave as a passive witness to someone else's critique. They implicate you in the systems you navigate, the privileges you carry, the silences you have kept, and the ones you have broken. They ask what it means to move through structures of power not just as an observer, but as a participant. As someone who, whether you choose it or not, is already inside.

The exhibition ends here. But the diagnosis does not. You carry it with you now. What you do with it is up to you.

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DIAGNOSING THE INSTITUTION:
ART, POWER, AND PARTICIPATION AT BEELITZ-HEILSTATTEN

ART EXHIBITION

COME AND JOIN WITH US!

August 11th – 23th, 2026
Diagnosing The Institution Art Exhibition
Straße nach Fichtenwalde 13, 14547 Beelitz, Germany



With, Special Guest Star
ZBIGNIEW LIBERA
LEGO. CONCENTRATION CAMP (OBÓZ KONCENTRACYJNY), 1996

Whitney Houston Haus

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Sample Exhibition Label Illustration & Tombstone



Zbigniew Libera (b. 1959)

LEGO. Concentration Camp (Obóz koncentracyjny), 1996

Box with Lego bricks

The photo, courtesy of the Museum of Modern Art in Warsaw (1996), consists of seven unique boxes containing Lego bricks, featuring varied box dimensions typical of standard Lego sets rather than a single fixed size. Various versions, including design drawings, range from approximately 9.84 x 9.45 in (approx. 25 x 24 cm).

Illustration Reference: A11.3

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Sample Exhibition Label (91 Words)

Zbigniew Libera's *Lego. Concentration Camp (Obóz koncentracyjny)* tears open a wound between innocence and atrocity. By forcing the architecture of genocide into the bright, snapping plastic of a children's toy, Libera confronts us with something unbearable. That history's darkest horrors can be packaged, sold, and forgotten. This is not reconstruction. It is provocation. Housed within a former institutional site, the work implicates the museum itself as a machine of control, one that sanitizes suffering into display. It demands we ask, with urgency, who holds the power to shape how we remember?

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Catalogue Entry Illustration



Hito Steyerl (b.1966)

How Not to Be Seen: A Fucking Didactic Educational .MOV File, 2013

Single-channel video installation, 30 min, Dimensions Variable, Lender: Andrew Kreps Gallery, New York.

Illustration Reference: A3.1

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Catatlogue Entry (584 Words)

In *How Not to Be Seen: A Fucking Didactic Educational .MOV File* (2013),[1] Hito Steyerl constructs a pointed paradox; an instructional video promising invisibility in an age of total visibility.[2] Hijacking the visual grammar of military training films, low-resolution graphics, and glitching digital renderings, the work exposes visibility itself as a mechanism of control. Where Trevor Paglen maps covert surveillance architectures, and Laura Poitras documents state secrecy, Steyerl works from within, deploying parody and didactic form to dismantle the presumed neutrality of image systems.[3] The result is a formally restless, ideologically precise interrogation of resolution as power.

Steyerl's central proposition is chilling in its precision: to be seen is not simply to exist; it is to be captured, classified, and potentially targeted.[4] Grounding the work in the legacy of aerial reconnaissance and digital mapping, she situates vision within a network of institutional power.[5] Visibility is not a neutral condition; it is one imposed and enforced by the systems that govern us. This extends Foucault's concept of disciplinary visibility, in which subjects internalize surveillance until the watcher no longer needs to watch, into the digital present.[6] Steyerl is equally indebted to Dada's destabilizing irony and conceptual art's weaponization of bureaucratic form, traditions that turned the language of authority against itself.[7] In the global

[1] Hito Steyerl, *How Not to Be Seen: A Fucking Didactic Educational .MOV File*, 2013, Single-channel video installation, 30 min, Lender: Andrew Kreps Gallery, New York, Description: A satirical tutorial on invisibility in the digital age, exploring surveillance, resolution, and the politics of visibility.
[2] Aja Segapeli. "Too Much, Not Enough: On Representation and Identity-Fraught Screen Culture." (2019). https://core.ac.uk/download/212411817.pdf.
[3] Joachim Friis. "Negotiations of In/Visibility: Surveillance in Hito Steyerl's How Not to be Seen." Surveillance & Society 19, no. 1 (2021). https://doi.org/10.24908/ss.v19i1.13950
[4] Amanda Wasielewski. "'No children were harmed': aesthetic infrastructures and ethical implications of AI-generated portraits." Media 47, no. 1 (2025): 1-17. https://doi.org/10.1080/1472586X.2025.2606201.
[5] Merve Emre. "Hito Steyerl's Digital Visions." The New Yorker, February 22, 2022. https://www.newyorker.com/culture/persons-of-interest/hito-steyerls-digital-visions.
[6] Joachim Friis. "Negotiations of In/Visibility: Surveillance in Hito Steyerl's How Not to be Seen." (2021).
[7] "Conceptual Art." Art in Context. 2024. https://artincontext.org/conceptual-art/.

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image economies she dissects, high resolution is a marker of power; low-resolution subjects, blurry, illegible, unrecognized, are erased not by absence but by the image's own indifference.[8]

Irony is the work's sharpest instrument. Commands like "become smaller than one pixel" are darkly comic, absurd precisely because they reveal how inescapable these systems have become.[9] Yet within the absurdity lies a genuine provocation: invisibility, Steyerl argues, can be a tactical withdrawal, a refusal to be legible to systems of capture. The reframing is bold but not uncomplicated. For many marginalized communities, enforced invisibility has historically meant erasure rather than freedom.[10] Steyerl holds both possibilities, invisibility as agency, invisibility as violence, in deliberate suspension, refusing resolution, and in doing so, sharpening the contradiction into critique.

Installed within the crumbling architecture of Beelitz-Heilstätten, a sanatorium where bodies were watched, measured, and classified, the work becomes inseparable from its setting.[11] The site's history of medical surveillance mirrors contemporary digital monitoring with unsettling exactness, collapsing the distance between historical and present disciplinary regimes. Here, Steyerl's critique acquires a physical, almost visceral weight that no white-cube installation could replicate.

Critical reception reflects the work's productive complexity. Scholars have read Steyerl's manipulation of resolution as a simultaneous critique of state and corporate scopic regimes; others foreground how her parody destabilizes institutional authority, dissolving the boundaries

[8] Claudio Celis. "Critical Surveillance Art in the Age of Machine Vision and Algorithmic Governmentality: Three Case Studies." Surveillance & Society 18, no. 3 (2020). https://doi.org/10.24908/ss.v18i3.13410.
[9] Steyerl 2024
[10] "Dysinclusion: naming and defining the inequitable absence of marginalized populations in health research." ScienceDirect (2026). https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jpsychores.2025.12.001.
[11] Steyerl 2024

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between art, activism, and documentary.[12] That these readings remain contested confirms the work's status not as a closed argument but as a live, urgent site of critical inquiry.[13]

The work also turns its gaze inward. Staging a critique of visibility inside an institution built on display, the exhibition implicates its own mechanisms of spectatorship, holding them to the same scrutiny it directs outward. Visitors are not passive observers; they are participants in a system that determines what can be perceived, what can be known, and who holds the power to decide.

Steyerl's work refuses resolution, and that refusal is its defining strength. Rather than resolving the contradictions of visibility, it holds them open, raw and demanding.[14] The invitation it extends is as urgent as it is uncomfortable; to locate ourselves within these systems, and to ask not only what is visible, but who decides, who disappears, and what power is exercised in that difference.

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[12] Joachim Friis. "Negotiations of In/Visibility: Surveillance in Hito Steyerl's How Not to be Seen." (2021).
[13] Joachim Friis. "Negotiations of In/Visibility: Surveillance in Hito Steyerl's How Not to be Seen." (2021).
[14] Joachim Friis. "Negotiations of In/Visibility: Surveillance in Hito Steyerl's How Not to be Seen." Surveillance & Society 19, no. 1 (2021): 69-80. https://doi.org/10.24908/ss.v19i1.13950.

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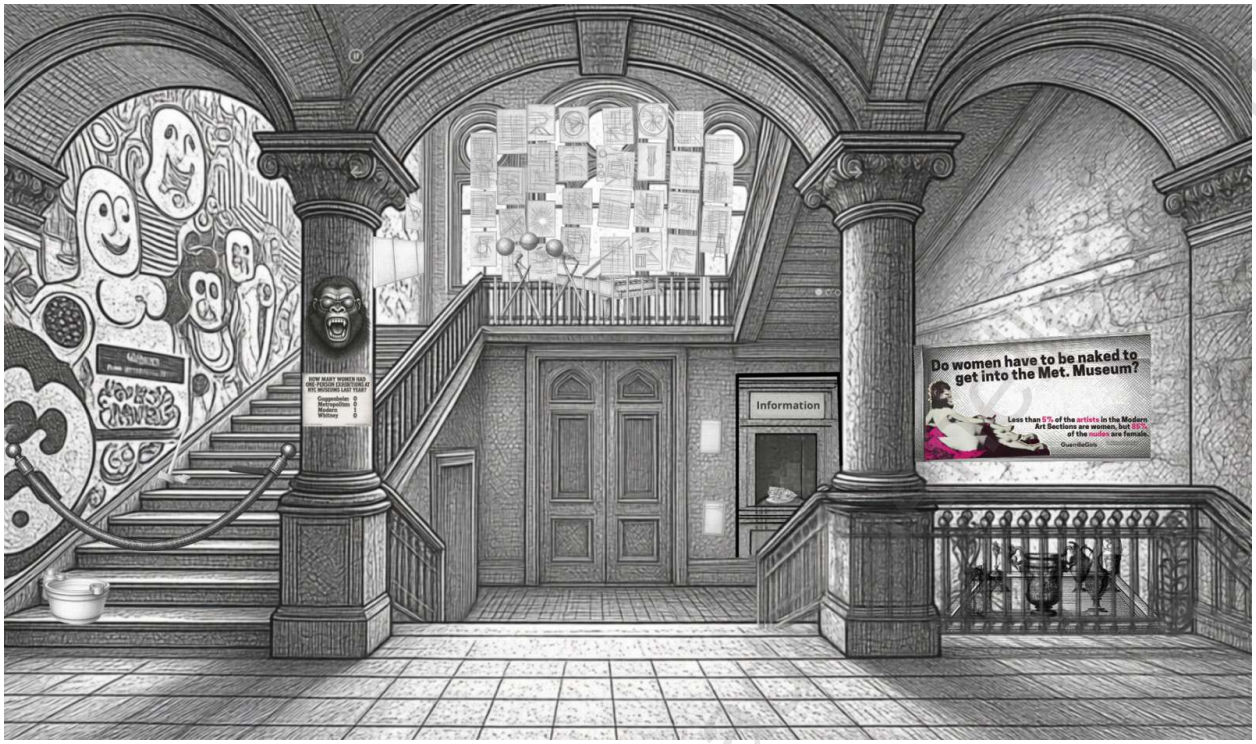
Extras (About the exhibition and images of the space)



Conceptual Outcome: The Beelitz-Heilstätten Gallery of Institutional Reflection transforms a site of medical treatment into a laboratory for cultural introspection. By juxtaposing the sanatorium's history of bodily healing with the museum's need for ideological rehabilitation, the project envisions a new model of cultural production, one that is transparent, participatory, and socially accountable.

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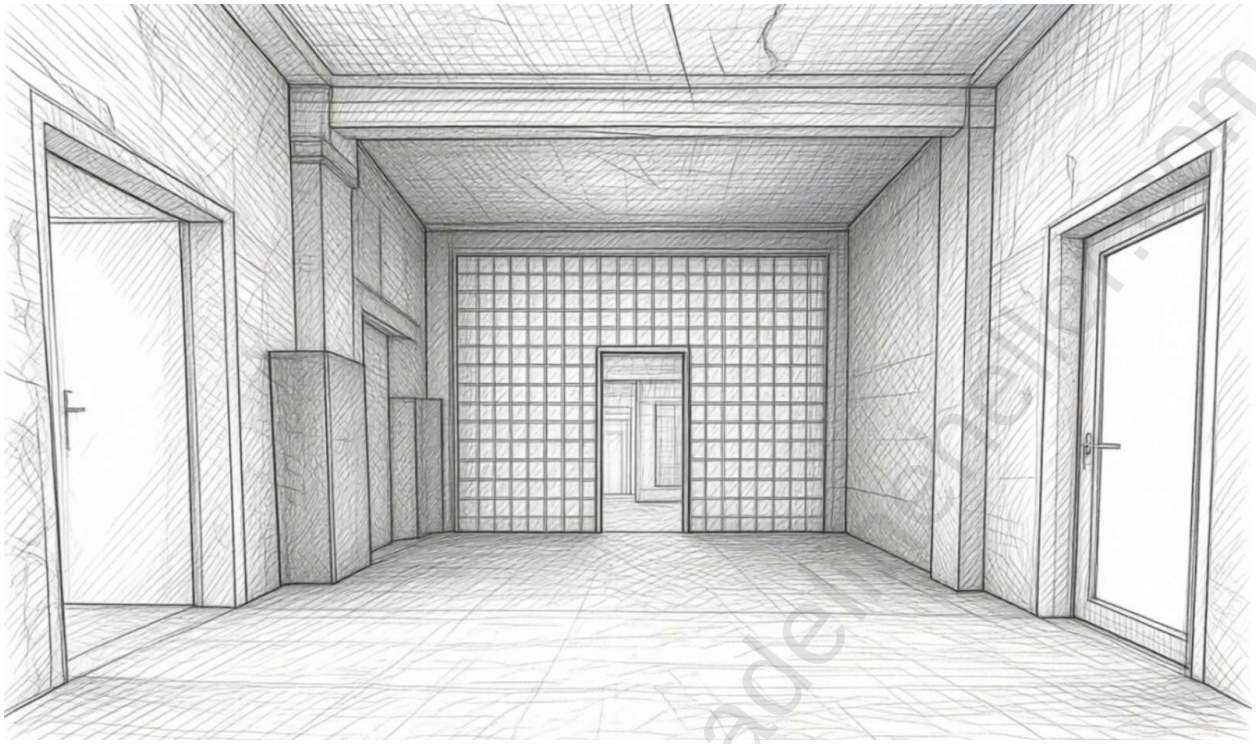


Illustration of space A8

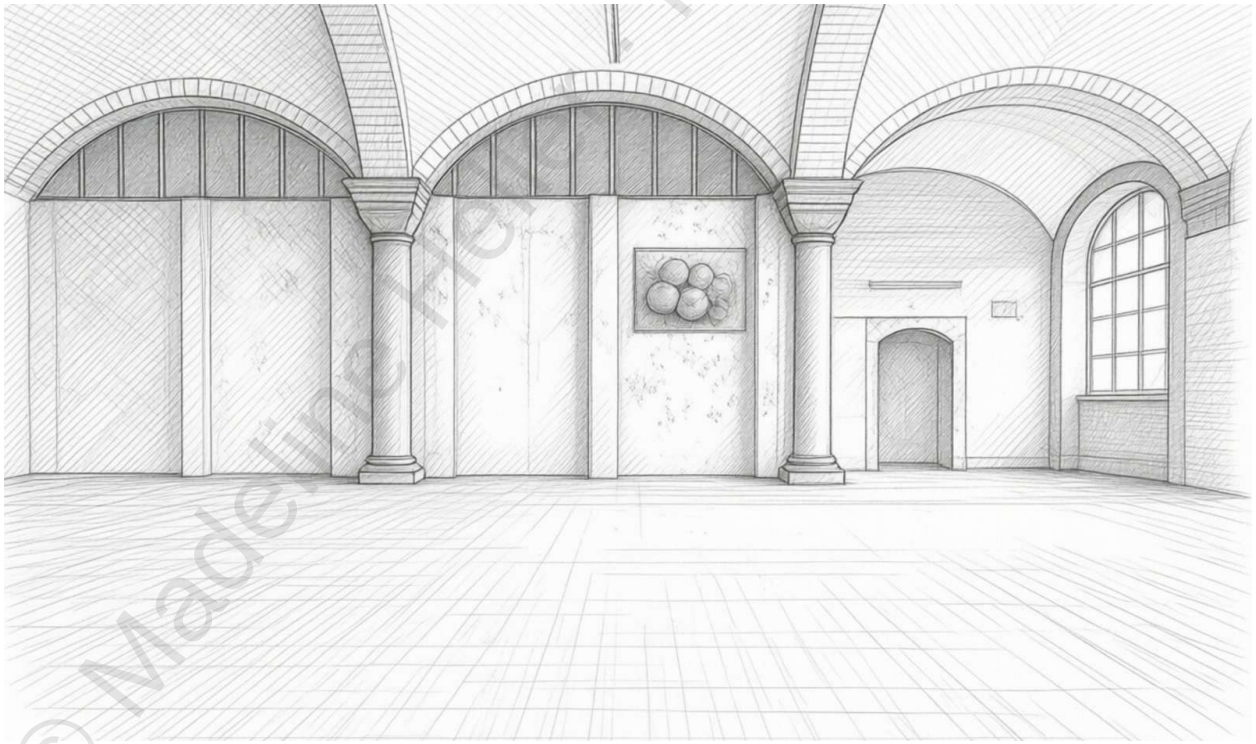
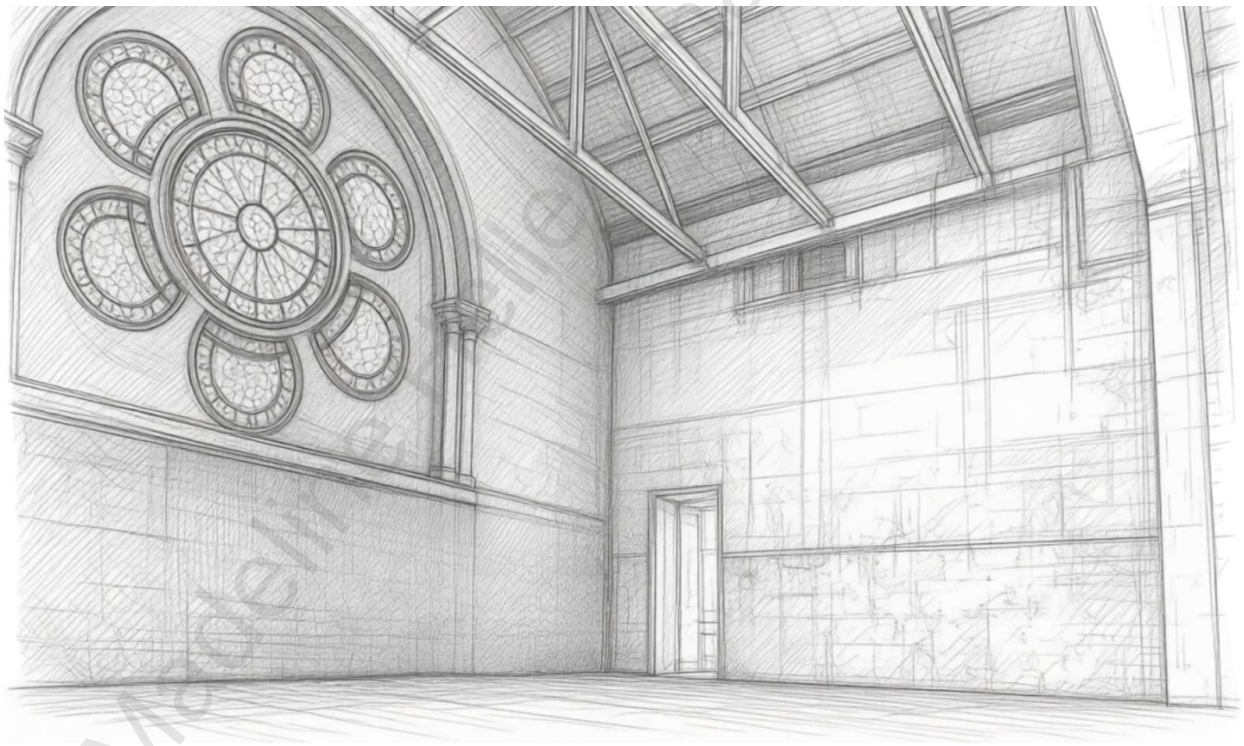


Illustration of space A11. Graffiti art is seen on the wall.

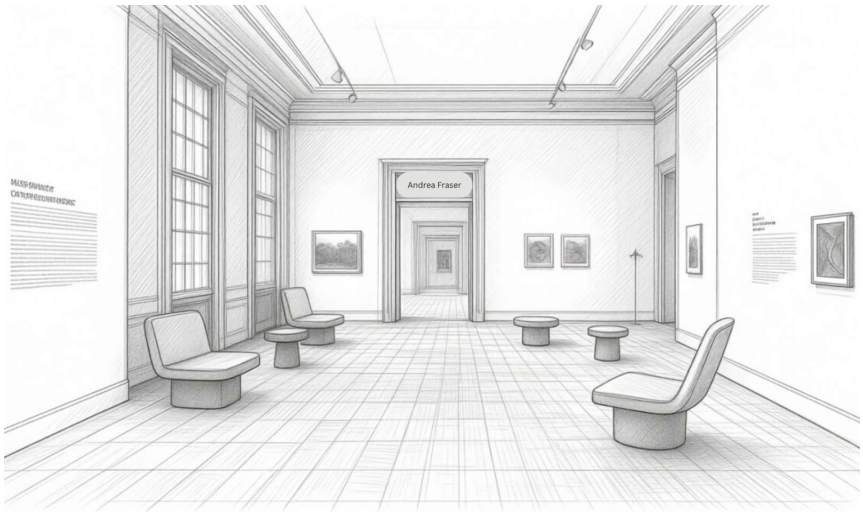
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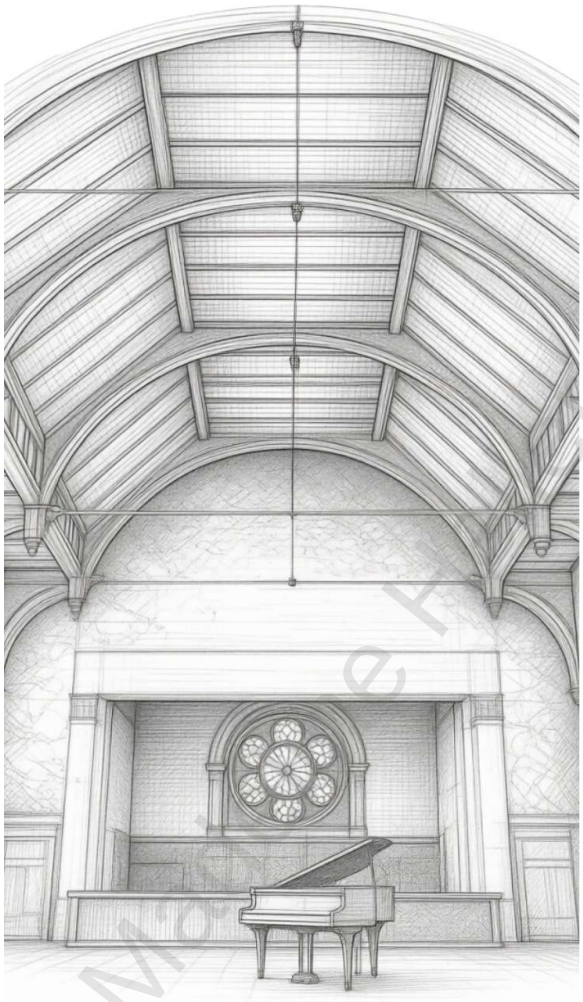




Illustrations of space A6.

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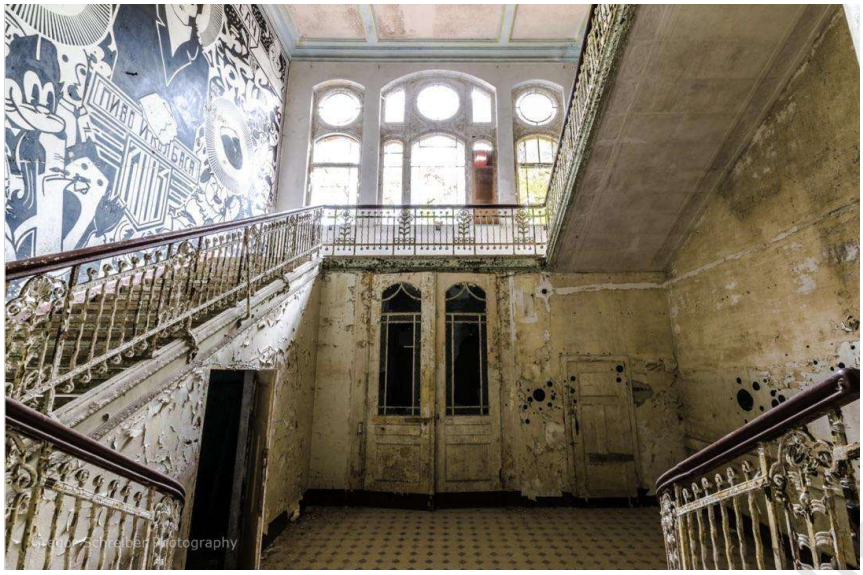
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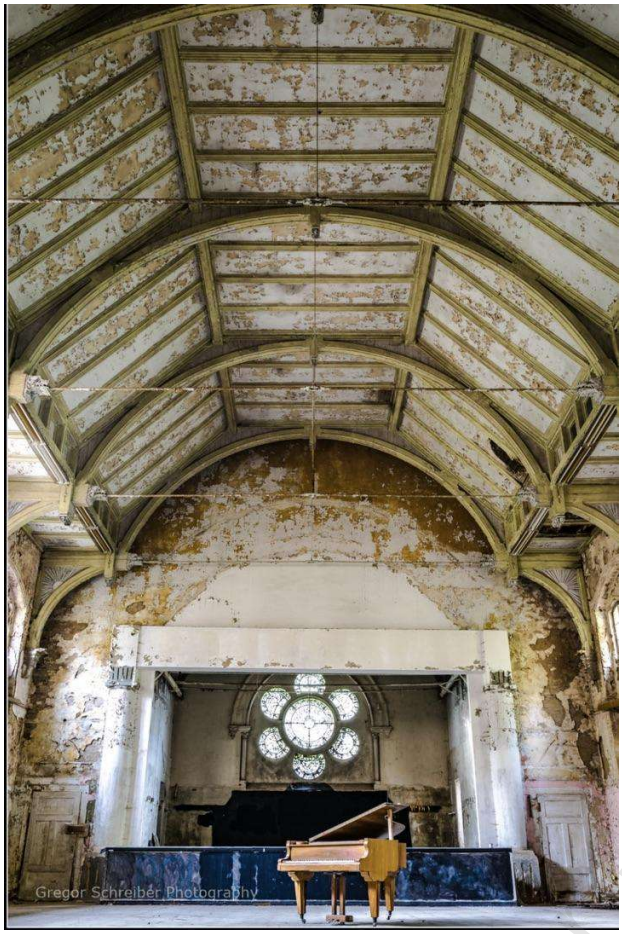
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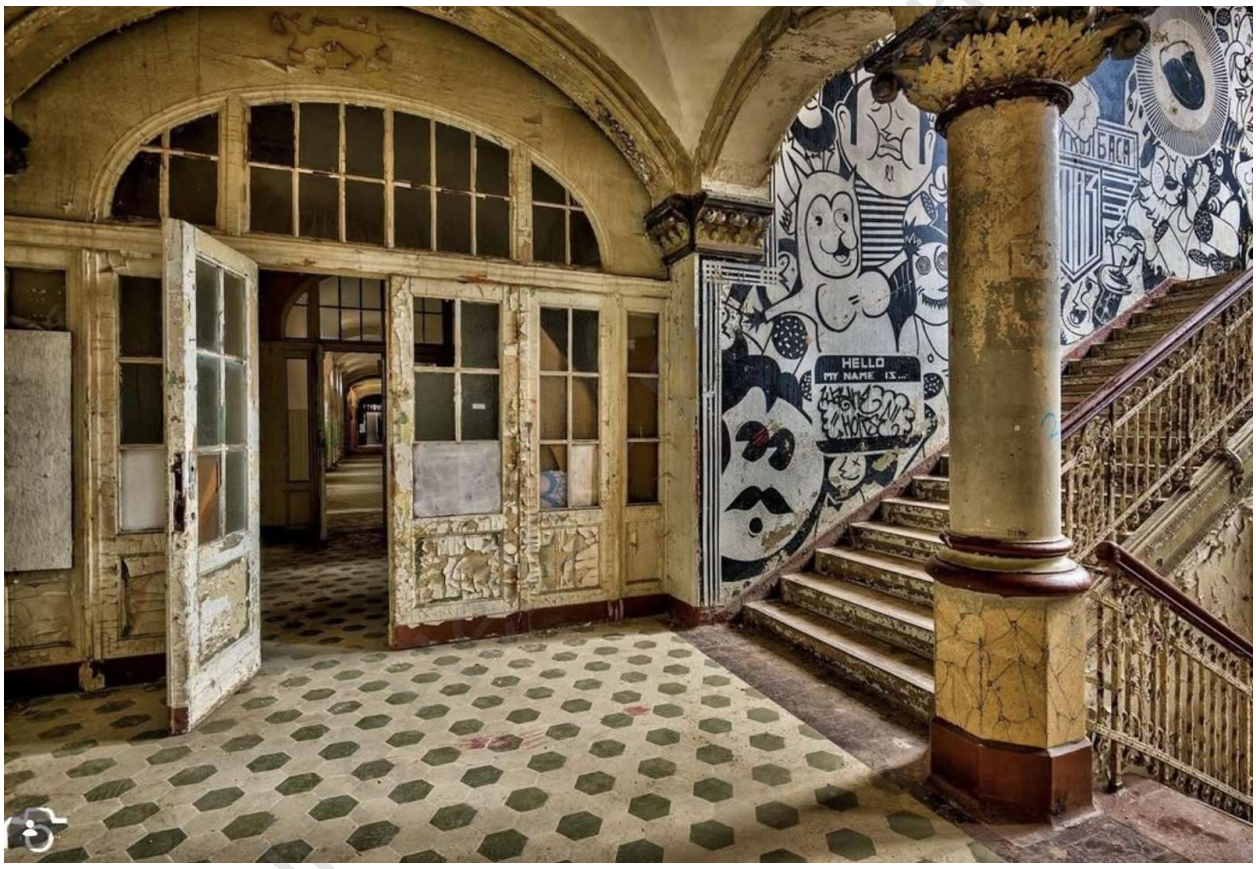




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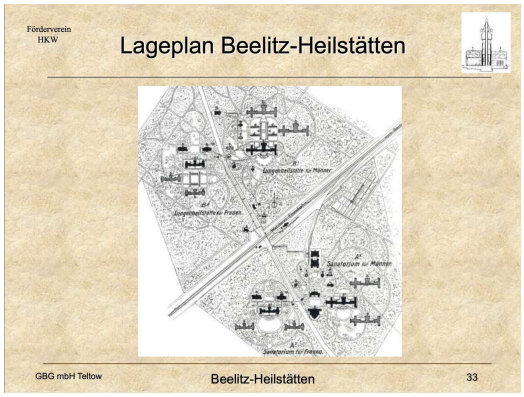


Photograph of the exterior porch.



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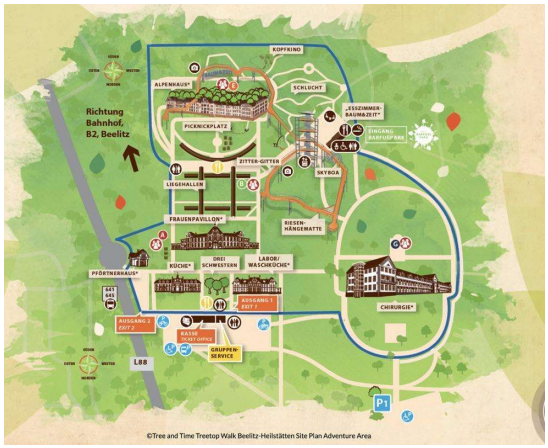




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©Tree and Time Treetop Walk Beelitz-Heilstätten Site Plan Adventure Area

Thank You!



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